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GEOGRAPHY · Andhra Pradesh: soils and vegetation

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is it? Day 34 covered India's soils and forests; today applies them to **Andhra Pradesh**. AP's soils follow its **rocks and rain**: old **granite** gives **red soils** in Rayalaseema and the uplands, **basalt-like and clayey** deposits give **black soils** in the west and Palnadu, and the rivers lay **rich alluvium** in the **Godavari–Krishna deltas**. Forests follow the **Eastern Ghats** and **rainfall**: wetter, taller forests in the north, dry deciduous and thorn forests in the south-west, and mangroves on the deltas. Learn it as **soil groups → soil problems → forest cover → forest types → trees and forest produce → protected areas → rare species**.

1. Soils of Andhra Pradesh

Soils of Andhra Pradesh

Soil	Where in AP	Nature and crops
Red soils (red sandy 'chalka', red loamy)	The **most widespread** soils of AP: **Anantapur, Sri Sathya Sai, Chittoor, Annamayya, YSR Kadapa**, parts of **Nellore, Prakasam**, and the uplands of **Srikakulam, Vizianagaram, Visakhapatnam**.	Formed from **granite and gneiss**; porous, light, poor in N, P and humus; low water-holding, so need irrigation and manure; **groundnut** (Anantapur is India's leading groundnut district), **millets, red gram**, and **horticulture** (mango, sweet orange, tomato).
Black soils ('regadi')	**Nandyal, Kurnool**, parts of **YSR Kadapa** and **Anantapur**, **Palnadu, Guntur, Prakasam** and the **Krishna** uplands.	Clayey; hold moisture; crack when dry; suit **rain-fed** crops: **cotton, chillies** (Guntur–Palnadu chillies), **jowar, Bengal gram, sunflower, tobacco** (Prakasam).
Deltaic alluvium	The **Godavari and Krishna deltas**: **East and West Godavari, Konaseema, Eluru, Krishna, NTR, Bapatla, Guntur**; smaller strips along the Pennar, Vamsadhara, Nagavali.	The **most fertile**; canal-irrigated; **paddy** (the 'rice bowl of AP'), **sugarcane, banana, coconut** (Konaseema), **aquaculture** in low-lying areas.
Laterite and hill soils	**Northern Eastern Ghats**: **Alluri Sitharama Raju, Parvathipuram Manyam**, hills of East Godavari and Srikakulam.	Leached, acidic; **coffee** (**Araku Valley coffee**, grown by tribal farmers, with a **GI tag**), **cashew, pepper**, millets; podu (shifting) cultivation on slopes; **bauxite** lies under parts of these hills.
Coastal sandy and	**Sandy** ridges along the whole coast (Srikakulam to Nellore); **saline** patches in	Sandy soils: **casuarina, coconut, cashew**, watermelon; saline/alkaline soils lower yields

saline/alkaline	**delta lowlands** and near the sea; **alkaline (chouḍu)** patches in dry, badly drained canal areas.	and are treated with **gypsum**, drainage and salt-tolerant crops.

- **Soil problems in AP: erosion** on the Ghats and in Rayalaseema (bare slopes, heavy bursts of rain); **salinity** spreading in the **delta lowlands** as brackish-water **aquaculture ponds** and **sea-water intrusion** spread (around **Kolleru**, Machilipatnam, Bhimavaram); **waterlogging** in over-irrigated canal areas; **desertification** risk in **Anantapur** (part of India's drought-prone belt). **Remedies:** watershed development, farm ponds, contour bunds, afforestation, gypsum, drip irrigation; **Soil Health Cards**; AP's push for **natural farming (APCNF, Rythu Sadhikara Samstha, since 2016)**, which builds soil organic matter.

2. Forests and vegetation

- **Forest cover:** AP's forest cover is a little under **one-fifth** of its area (roughly **18–19%** in the **India State of Forest Report**), and its **recorded forest area** is a little over **one-fifth** (about **23%**); both are well below the **33%** national goal. The largest forest areas are in the **Nallamala** belt and the **northern Agency** districts. (Use the latest ISFR figures for exact numbers.)

Forest types of Andhra Pradesh

Topic	Details
Important trees and produce	**Red sanders** (*Pterocarpus santalinus*, 'erra chandanam'): **endemic** to the **Seshachalam, Palakonda, Lankamala, Velikonda** hills; prized for its deep-red wood; heavily **smuggled**; listed as **Endangered** (IUCN) and in **CITES** (trade controlled). **Teak, nallamaddi** (*Terminalia*), **yegi** (*Pterocarpus marsupium*), **sandalwood, bamboo** (paper mills), **rosewood**. **Minor forest produce** collected by tribal people: **tendu (beedi) leaves, tamarind, honey, adda leaves, gum karaya, myrobalans (karakkaya), soap nuts**; bought by the **Girijan Cooperative Corporation (GCC, Visakhapatnam)**.
State symbols	**Tree: neem** (vepa); **animal: blackbuck** (krishna jinka); **bird: rose-ringed parakeet** (rama chiluka); **flower: jasmine** (malle).
Protected areas	**Nagarjunasagar–Srisailam Tiger Reserve** (Nallamala; **India's largest tiger reserve** by area). **National parks: Sri Venkateswara** (Tirupati; Seshachalam hills; Talakona falls nearby), **Papikonda** (Godavari gorge), **Rajiv Gandhi (Rameswaram)** (Kadapa region). **Seshachalam Biosphere Reserve (2010)**. **Sanctuaries: Coringa** (mangroves, Kakinada), **Krishna** (mangroves), **Kolleru** (pelicans; **Ramsar site, 2002**), **Pulicat**, **Nelapattu** (bird sanctuary; pelicans, painted storks), **Rollapadu** (Nandyal; **great Indian bustard**, blackbuck), **Sri Lankamalleswara** (Kadapa; where the **Jerdon's courser** was **rediscovered in 1986**), **Koundinya** (Chittoor; **elephants**), **Kambalakonda** (Visakhapatnam), **Gundla Brahmeswaram**, **Sri Penusila Narasimha**.

OTHER ANGLES ASKED IN EXAMS

Other angles asked: (1) **Endemic vs endangered**: red sanders is both endemic (found only here) and endangered. (2) **Golden gecko** and the **slender loris** occur in the Eastern Ghats forests; the **Jerdon's**

courser is among India's rarest birds. (3) **Mangroves as cyclone shields**: villages behind Coringa suffered less in past cyclones. (4) **Podu cultivation** and the **Forest Rights Act, 2006** (tribal land titles) come up in Agency-area questions. (5) **Araku coffee** won international awards; tribal **GI products** (Araku coffee, Etikoppaka toys from **ankudu** wood) link forests to livelihoods. (6) **Social forestry**: casuarina and eucalyptus plantations on the coast supply **paper mills** (e.g. Rajamahendravaram).

EXAM TRAP

Soils: **red (most widespread; granite; Anantapur, Sathya Sai, Chittoor, Annamayya, Kadapa; groundnut, millets, horticulture)**; **black/regadi (Nandyal, Kurnool, Palnadu, Guntur, Prakasam; cotton, chillies, jowar, Bengal gram, tobacco)**; **deltaic alluvium (Godavari–Krishna; paddy, sugarcane, coconut, aquaculture)**; **laterite (northern Ghats; Araku coffee GI, cashew; bauxite)**; **coastal sandy (casuarina, coconut)**; **saline/alkaline (chouḍu) → gypsum**; problems: erosion, **delta salinity (aquaculture, sea-water)**, waterlogging, **Anantapur desertification**; **APCNF 2016**; forest cover **~18–19%**, recorded **~23%**; types: **dry deciduous (largest)**, moist deciduous (north), **thorn (Anantapur)**, dry evergreen (coast), **mangroves (Coringa, Krishna)**; **red sanders: endemic Seshachalam–Palakonda–Lankamala–Velikonda; Endangered; CITES**; teak, nallamaddi, yegi, sandalwood, bamboo; MFP: tendu, tamarind, honey, adda, **GCC Visakhapatnam**; symbols: **neem, blackbuck, rose-ringed parakeet, jasmine**; **NSTR largest tiger reserve**; NPs: **Sri Venkateswara, Papikonda, Rajiv Gandhi (Rameswaram)**; **Seshachalam BR 2010**; **Kolleru Ramsar 2002**; **Nelapattu, Pulicat, Coringa, Krishna**; **Rollapadu (great Indian bustard)**; **Sri Lankamalleswara (Jerdon's courser, 1986)**; **Koundinya (elephants)**; **FRA 2006**.

Test yourself: 8 questions (tap an option to see the answer)

PRACTICE

Consider the following statements about Andhra Pradesh:
1. Red soils are the most widespread soils of the State.
2. Black soils are common in the Nandyal–Kurnool region and Palnadu.
3. The Godavari–Krishna deltas have rich alluvial soils.
4. Laterite soils dominate the Rayalaseema plateau.
Which of the above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only

B. 2, 3 and 4 only

C. 1, 2 and 3 only

D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: C. Laterite soils occur mainly in the northern Eastern Ghats; Rayalaseema is dominated by red soils, with black soils in parts.

PRACTICE

Match List-I (species or habitat) with List-II (protected area):

List-I (species or habitat)	List-II (protected area)
A. Jerdon's courser	1. Coringa
B. Great Indian bustard	2. Nelapattu
C. Pelicans and painted storks nesting in village trees	3. Rollapadu
D. Mangrove forest	4. Sri Lankamalleswara

(1) A → 4 B → 3 C → 2 D → 1

(2) A → 3 B → 4 C → 2 D → 1

(3) A → 4 B → 2 C → 3 D → 1

(4) A → 4 B → 3 C → 1 D → 2

Answer: (1) Jerdon's courser: Sri Lankamalleswara; great Indian bustard: Rollapadu; pelicans: Nelapattu; mangroves: Coringa.

PRACTICE

Which one of the following statements is NOT correct?

A. The State tree of Andhra Pradesh is the neem.

B. The blackbuck is the State animal of Andhra Pradesh.

C. The Nagarjunasagar–Srisailam Tiger Reserve is India's largest tiger reserve by area.

D. Red sanders grows naturally mainly in the Papikondalu hills of the Godavari.

Answer: D. Red sanders is endemic to the Seshachalam, Palakonda, Lankamala and Velikonda hills of southern AP.

PRACTICE

Assertion (A): The deltaic soils of the Godavari and Krishna are among the most fertile in Andhra Pradesh.

Reason (R): The coastal districts of Andhra Pradesh are often hit by cyclones.

Choose the correct answer:

A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

C. A is true but R is false

D. A is false but R is true

Answer: B. Both are true, but fertility comes from fresh river silt (alluvium), not from cyclones.

PRACTICE

A farmer in Anantapur district has light, porous red sandy soil and gets low, uncertain rain. Which crop has traditionally been the district's main crop under these conditions?

A. Jute

B. Tea

C. Groundnut

D. Rubber

Answer: C. Groundnut suits light red soils and low rainfall; Anantapur is one of India's leading groundnut districts.

PRACTICE

Consider the following statements:
I. Tropical dry deciduous forests cover the largest share of Andhra Pradesh's forest area.
II. Tropical evergreen rain forests are the main forest type of the Rayalaseema region.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. I only

B. II only

C. Both I and II

D. Neither I nor II

Answer: A. Rayalaseema is dry; its forests are dry deciduous and thorn, not evergreen.

PRACTICE

Consider the following pairs:

1. Sri Venkateswara National Park – Seshachalam hills

2. Papikonda National Park – Godavari gorge

3. Kolleru – Ramsar site in the Rayalaseema region

4. Seshachalam – Biosphere reserve

How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?

A. Only one pair

B. Only two pairs

C. Only three pairs

D. All four pairs

Answer: C. Kolleru is a Ramsar site, but it lies between the Godavari and Krishna deltas on the coast, not in Rayalaseema. The other three pairs are correct.

PRACTICE

In the low-lying parts of the Godavari–Krishna deltas, the spread of brackish-water aquaculture ponds and sea-water intrusion is mainly causing which soil problem?

A. Laterisation

B. Salinisation

C. Wind erosion and sand dunes

D. Formation of black cotton soil

Answer: B. Salt water from ponds and the sea raises the salt content of delta soils (salinisation), reducing crop yields.

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

1. Write AP's five soil groups with districts and crops, and the soil problems with remedies. 2. Write forest cover, the forest types with regions and trees, red sanders and minor forest produce. 3. Write the State symbols and the protected areas with their special species.

ECONOMY · Inflation: causes and remedies

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is it? Inflation is a **sustained rise in the general price level**, so each rupee buys **less** than before. One costly item does not make inflation; the **average price of a basket** of goods and services must keep rising. It is measured as a **percentage change in a price index** over a year: **Inflation rate = (Index this year − Index last year) ÷ Index last year × 100**. Mild, steady inflation (around **4%**) is normal in a growing economy; high or very low inflation both hurt. Learn it as **meaning → kinds by cause and speed → related terms → how India measures it → who gains and who loses → remedies → India's target and trend**.

1. Kinds and causes

Inflation: kinds and causes

Kind	What causes it
Demand-pull	**'Too much money chasing too few goods'**: demand rises faster than output because of higher incomes, **government spending and deficits**, cheap credit, rising **money supply**, or a sudden rush (festivals, panic buying).
Cost-push	Costs of production rise and firms pass them on: **crude oil** prices, **wages**, raw materials, **indirect taxes**, a **weaker rupee** (costlier imports). A **wage-price spiral** (built-in inflation) happens when workers demand higher wages to match prices, which raises costs again.
Structural (India)	Supply-side weaknesses: **monsoon-dependent farming**, poor **storage and cold chains**, middlemen and **hoarding**, weak transport. This is why **food items** (vegetables like **tomato, onion, potato**, and **pulses**) cause sharp price spikes in India.

- **By speed: creeping** (below about **3%** a year), **walking/trotting** (3–10%), **galloping/running** (double digits), **hyperinflation** (prices rise **50% or more a month**; e.g. Germany 1923, Zimbabwe 2008, Venezuela). **Related terms: deflation** = a sustained **fall** in prices (inflation below zero; harms output, as in Japan); **disinflation** = the **rate** of inflation **falls** but prices still rise (e.g. from 7% to 4%); **reflation** = deliberate policy to lift prices and output after a slump; **stagflation** = **high inflation + stagnant growth + high unemployment** (1970s oil shocks); **skewflation** = prices of **a few items** (e.g. onions) rise sharply while others stay steady; **headline inflation** covers the **whole basket**; **core inflation excludes volatile food and fuel**.

2. Measuring inflation in India

How inflation is measured in India

- **WPI** (Wholesale Price Index; Office of the Economic Adviser, **DPIIT**, Ministry of Commerce and Industry; **base 2011–12**) covers **goods only** at the first point of bulk sale: **primary articles, fuel and power, manufactured products** (the largest weight). **CPI** (Consumer Price Index; **National Statistics Office, MoSPI**; **base 2012**; a **revised series with base 2024** is being introduced in **2026**, so check the base year in your source) covers **retail prices of goods and services** that households buy; **food and beverages** have the

largest weight. The RBI moved from WPI to **CPI-Combined** as its main measure in **2014** (Urjit Patel Committee), since CPI reflects what people actually pay.

- **Who gains and who loses: losers**: people on **fixed incomes** (pensioners, salaried without DA), **savers and creditors** (money repaid is worth less), the **poor** (most of their income goes on food); exports become less competitive. **Gainers**: **debtors** (including the government), businesses whose prices rise faster than costs, holders of **real assets** (land, gold). **Real interest rate = nominal rate − inflation**. The **Phillips curve** shows a short-run **trade-off**: lower unemployment comes with higher inflation. Inflation also works as a hidden **'inflation tax'** on cash holders.

3. Remedies

Measure	How it works
Monetary (RBI)	**Raise the repo rate**, CRR or SLR; **sell government securities (OMO)**; tighter selective credit controls. Loans become **costlier and scarcer**, so demand cools. Works best on **demand-pull** inflation, with a **time lag**.
Fiscal (Government)	**Cut unproductive spending**, **reduce the fiscal deficit**, raise direct taxes, **cut indirect taxes/excise on fuel** to lower costs, public borrowing from the market rather than the RBI.
Supply-side (direct)	Release **buffer stocks** (FCI's **Open Market Sale Scheme** for wheat and rice); **imports** and lower import duty (pulses, edible oil); **export bans/limits** (e.g. on onion, wheat, non-basmati rice at times); **stock limits** on traders against hoarding (**Essential Commodities Act, 1955**); the **Price Stabilisation Fund (2014–15)** for onion and pulses buffers; **Operation Greens (TOP)** for tomato, onion, potato; **PDS** and subsidised sales (**Bharat atta, Bharat dal**); better storage and cold chains in the long run.

- **India's target and trend:** under the **flexible inflation targeting** framework (2016), CPI inflation is to be kept at **4%** within a **2–6%** band. Inflation was high in **2022** (above 7% at times, after the Ukraine war pushed up fuel and food). It then **fell sharply** through **2025** (helped by cheap food and the **GST rate cuts of September 2025**), reaching record lows; by **late 2026** price pressures had returned enough for the RBI to **raise the repo rate in October 2026**. Check the **latest monthly CPI release** (published around the **12th** of each month).

OTHER ANGLES ASKED IN EXAMS

Other angles asked: (1) **Base effect**: a low index last year makes this year's inflation rate look high, and vice versa, even if prices barely moved. (2) **GDP deflator** is the **widest** measure (all goods and services, including exports and investment goods) but is **quarterly**, not monthly. (3) **WPI and CPI can diverge**: e.g. WPI was **negative** in parts of 2023 while CPI stayed around 5%, because WPI has no services and more fuel and metals. (4) **Dearness Allowance** for Central employees is linked to **CPI-IW**; **MGNREGA wages** to **CPI-AL**. (5) **Inflation-indexed bonds** and **inflation targeting** are favourite statement questions. (6) **Laffer curve** is about **taxes**, not inflation; do not confuse it with the **Phillips curve**.

EXAM TRAP

Inflation = sustained rise in general price level; rate = (new − old) ÷ old × 100; **demand-pull** ('too much money, too few goods'; deficits, credit), **cost-push** (oil, wages, taxes, weak rupee; **wage-price spiral**), **structural** (monsoon, storage, hoarding; **TOP, pulses**); **creeping <3, walking 3–10, galloping 10+, hyper ≥50%/month**; **deflation** (fall), **disinflation** (rate falls), **reflation**, **stagflation (inflation + stagnation + unemployment)**, **skewflation** (few items), **headline vs core (no food, fuel)**; **WPI: DPIIT, base 2011–12, goods only, manufactured largest weight**; **CPI: NSO/MoSPI, base 2012 (new 2024 series from 2026), food largest weight, RBI target since 2014**; **CPI-IW (Labour Bureau, 2016; DA)**; **CPI-AL/RL (MGNREGA)**; **GDP deflator widest, quarterly**; losers: fixed income, savers, creditors, poor; gainers: debtors, real assets; **real rate = nominal − inflation**; **Phillips curve**; remedies: **monetary (repo, CRR, OMO sell)**, **fiscal (cut deficit, tax changes)**, **supply (OMSS, imports, export bans, stock limits, EC Act 1955, PSF 2014–15, Operation Greens, PDS, Bharat atta/dal)**; **target 4% ± 2**; **base effect**.

Test yourself: 8 questions (tap an option to see the answer)

PRACTICE

Consider the following statements:

1. The WPI measures price changes at the wholesale level and is compiled by the Office of the Economic Adviser, DPIIT.

2. The CPI (Combined) is compiled by the National Statistics Office.

3. The RBI's inflation target is defined in terms of CPI inflation.

4. Core inflation includes food and fuel prices.

Which of the above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only

B. 1, 2 and 3 only

C. 2, 3 and 4 only

D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: B. Core inflation excludes volatile food and fuel prices.

PRACTICE

Match List-I (term) with List-II (meaning):

List-I (term)	List-II (meaning)
A. Demand-pull inflation	**1.** The rate of inflation falls but prices still rise
B. Cost-push inflation	**2.** High inflation with slow growth and high unemployment
C. Stagflation	**3.** A rise in crude oil prices raises production costs

D. Disinflation	**4.** Too much money chasing too few goods

(1) A → 3 B → 4 C → 2 D → 1

(2) A → 4 B → 3 C → 1 D → 2

(3) A → 4 B → 2 C → 3 D → 1

(4) A → 4 B → 3 C → 2 D → 1

Answer: (4) Demand-pull: too much money; cost-push: oil costs; stagflation: inflation with stagnation; disinflation: slower rate of rise.

PRACTICE

Which one of the following statements is NOT correct?

A. Inflation benefits creditors and people with fixed incomes.

B. Inflation generally benefits debtors.

C. The real interest rate is the nominal rate minus the rate of inflation.

D. Food has the largest weight in India's CPI.

Answer: A. Inflation hurts creditors and fixed-income earners, since money repaid or received buys less.

PRACTICE

Assertion (A): Raising the repo rate is a tool to control inflation.
Reason (R): Raising the repo rate increases the money supply in the economy.
Choose the correct answer:

A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

C. A is true but R is false

D. A is false but R is true

Answer: C. A is true. R is false: a higher repo rate makes credit costlier and reduces the growth of money supply.

PRACTICE

A price index was 200 last year and is 210 this year. What is the rate of inflation?

A. 10%

B. 2%

C. 4.76%

D. 5%

Answer: D. (210 − 200) ÷ 200 × 100 = 5%. (4.76% would wrongly divide by the new index.)

PRACTICE

Consider the following statements:

I. Hyperinflation means inflation of about 3–5% a year.

II. Deflation means a sustained fall in the general price level.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. I only

B. II only

C. Both I and II

D. Neither I nor II

Answer: B. 3–5% a year is creeping or mild inflation; hyperinflation means prices rising 50% or more a month.

PRACTICE

Consider the following pairs:

1. WPI – base year 2011–12

2. CPI-IW – compiled by the RBI

3. GDP deflator – covers only consumer goods

4. Skewflation – prices of all goods rise equally

How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?

A. Only one pair

B. Only two pairs

C. Only three pairs

D. All four pairs

Answer: A. Only pair 1 is correct. CPI-IW is compiled by the Labour Bureau; the GDP deflator covers all goods and services; skewflation is a sharp rise in a few items only.

PRACTICE

Onion and pulse prices are rising sharply because of a poor harvest, while other prices are stable. Which of the following is a supply-side measure the Government can use immediately?

A. Raising the Cash Reserve Ratio

B. Raising income tax rates

C. Releasing buffer stocks into the market and allowing duty-free imports

D. Selling government securities in the open market

Answer: C. This is skewflation from a supply shortage; adding supply (buffer stocks, imports) acts fastest. The other options reduce overall demand.

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

1. Write the meaning, the formula, the three causes and the kinds by speed, plus the related terms. 2. Write each index (agency, base, coverage, use) and who gains and loses. 3. Write the monetary, fiscal and supply-side remedies with examples, the target, the trend and the base effect.

SCIENCE · Healthcare delivery, outcomes and recent public health programmes

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is it? Healthcare delivery is **how care reaches people**: who gives it (government, private, AYUSH), where (sub-centre to super-speciality hospital) and who pays (government, insurance or the patient). **Health outcomes** are the results, measured by indicators such as **infant mortality, maternal mortality and life expectancy**. Health is a **State subject** (**Seventh Schedule, State List, entry 6**), but the Centre funds major missions; the Supreme Court reads the **right to health** into **Article 21**, and **Article 47** asks the State to improve **nutrition and public health**. Learn it as **the tiers → National Health Mission → Ayushman Bharat and digital health → outcome indicators → spending → programmes for mothers and children → newer missions → AP**.

1. How care is delivered

Tiers of public health care

- The tiers follow the **Bhore Committee (1946)** idea of primary health centres and are set by the **Indian Public Health Standards (IPHS)**. The **National Rural Health Mission (NRHM, 2005)** and **National Urban Health Mission (2013)** together form the **National Health Mission (NHM)**: it created the **ASHA** (**Accredited Social Health Activist**; a local woman, about **one per 1,000** people, who links families to services), **Rogi Kalyan Samitis**, the **108 ambulance** network and free drugs and diagnostics. **AYUSH** (Ayurveda, Yoga, Unani, Siddha, Sowa-Rigpa, Homoeopathy) has had its own **ministry since 2014**. The **National Medical Commission (2020)**, under the **NMC Act 2019**, replaced the **Medical Council of India**.

Ayushman Bharat and digital health	Details
Ayushman Arogya Mandirs (earlier Health and Wellness Centres, 2018)	Sub-centres and PHCs upgraded to give **comprehensive primary care**: screening for BP, diabetes, cancers; maternal and child care; free drugs and tests; yoga; run by a **Community Health Officer (CHO)**; renamed **December 2023**.
PM Jan Arogya Yojana (PM-JAY, September 2018)	The world's largest government-funded **health assurance** scheme: **₹5 lakh per family per year** for **secondary and tertiary hospital care**, **cashless and paperless**, at empanelled public and private hospitals; families chosen from **SECC 2011** data plus later additions; run by the **National Health Authority**. Since **October 2024**, **all people aged 70 and above**, whatever their income, are covered with an extra ₹5 lakh top-up via the **Ayushman Vay Vandana card**.
Digital and medicines	**Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM, 2021)**: a 14-digit **ABHA** health ID and linked health records; **e-Sanjeevani** (free **telemedicine**); **PM Bhartiya Janaushadhi Pariyojana** (cheap **generic medicines** at Jan Aushadhi Kendras); **PM-ABHIM (2021)** for critical-care blocks and labs.

2. Outcomes and spending

Indicator	Meaning and recent level (check the latest SRS/NFHS)
Infant Mortality Rate (IMR)	Deaths of infants **under 1 year per 1,000 live births**: about **26–27** (SRS 2021–22), down from about 80 in 1990; lowest in **Kerala**, highest in States like **MP, UP, Chhattisgarh**.
Maternal Mortality Ratio (MMR)	Maternal deaths per **1,00,000 live births**: **93 (2019–21)**, down from 130 (2014–16); the **SDG target** is **below 70 by 2030**; Kerala, Maharashtra, Telangana, AP and others have already met it.
Others	**Under-5 mortality** about **30**, **neonatal mortality** about **19** (per 1,000); **TFR 2.0** (NFHS-5; replacement level is **2.1**); **life expectancy** about **70 years**; **institutional deliveries 88.6%** and **full immunisation 76.4%** (NFHS-5).

Spending	The **National Health Policy 2017** set a goal of **government health spending at 2.5% of GDP by 2025**; actual government spending is under **2%**. The **out-of-pocket** share of total health spending fell from about **64% (2013–14)** to about **39–40% (2021–22)** (National Health Accounts), still high: illness pushes many families into **debt and poverty**.

3. Programmes

- **Mothers and children: Janani Suraksha Yojana (2005)**: cash for **institutional delivery**; **Janani Shishu Suraksha Karyakram (2011)**: **free** delivery, C-section, drugs and transport; **PM Surakshit Matritva Abhiyan (2016)**: free antenatal check-up by a specialist on the **9th of every month**; **LaQshya (2017)**: quality labour rooms; **SUMAN (2019)**: assured respectful maternity care; **PM Matru Vandana Yojana (2017)**: cash for the first child (and a second if a girl, since 2022); **Rashtriya Bal Swasthya Karyakram (RBSK, 2013)**: screens children for the **'4 Ds'**: **defects at birth, diseases, deficiencies, developmental delays**; **Rashtriya Kishor Swasthya Karyakram (2014)** for adolescents; **Mission Indradhanush (2014)**, **U-WIN** for vaccines.
- **Newer missions: PM National Dialysis Programme (2016)**: free dialysis at district hospitals; **Tele-MANAS (October 2022)**: a 24×7 **mental health helpline (14416)**, under the **Mental Healthcare Act 2017** spirit (which also **decriminalised suicide attempts**); **National Sickle Cell Anaemia Elimination Mission (July 2023**, launched at **Shahdol**, MP): screen **7 crore** people in tribal areas, eliminate as a public health problem by **2047**; **TB Mukt Bharat**, **NP-NCD** screening (Day 35); **Pradhan Mantri TB Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan** with **Ni-kshay Mitras** (community donors).
- **Andhra Pradesh:** the State's own health assurance scheme began as **Aarogyasri (2007**, in united AP**)**, later renamed **Dr NTR Vaidya Seva** (2024); it works alongside PM-JAY. AP also runs **village/ward health clinics** linked to the secretariats, **104 mobile medical units** and **108 ambulances**, and has met the **SDG target for MMR**. (Check the latest name, cover amount and any new universal insurance model the State notifies.)

OTHER ANGLES ASKED IN EXAMS

Other angles asked: (1) **IMR is per 1,000 live births; MMR is per 1,00,000 live births**; mixing the bases is a classic trap. (2) **Sample Registration System (SRS)** is run by the **Registrar General of India**; **NFHS** by the **Health Ministry with IIPS Mumbai**. (3) **Health is a State subject**, but **population control and family planning** is in the **Concurrent List**. (4) **Alma-Ata Declaration (1978)**: 'Health for All' through primary health care. (5) The doctor-population ratio is often quoted as better than the **WHO norm of 1:1,000** only when **AYUSH doctors** are counted. (6) **NITI Aayog's Health Index** ranks States; **Kerala** usually tops the large States.

EXAM TRAP

Health: State List (entry 6); **Art 21 (right to health), Art 47**; **Bhore 1946**; **IPHS**; tiers: **sub-centre 5,000/3,000; PHC 30,000/20,000; CHC 1,20,000/80,000 (4 specialists, 30 beds, FRU)**; district; tertiary; **NRHM 2005 + NUHM 2013 = NHM**; **ASHA ~1/1,000**; **108**; **AYUSH ministry 2014**; **NMC 2020 (Act 2019) replaced MCI**; **Ayushman Bharat 2018: Arogya Mandirs (renamed Dec 2023; CHO) + PM-JAY (₹5 lakh/family/year; SECC 2011; NHA; 70+ all from Oct 2024, Vay Vandana)**; **ABDM 2021 (ABHA)**; **e-Sanjeevani**; **Jan Aushadhi**; **PM-ABHIM 2021**; **IMR ~26–27/1,000 (SRS)**; **MMR 93 (2019–21)/1,00,000;**

SDG <70; U5MR ~30, NMR ~19; **TFR 2.0 (replacement 2.1)**; life expectancy ~70; **institutional deliveries 88.6%, full immunisation 76.4% (NFHS-5)**; **NHP 2017: 2.5% GDP by 2025**; govt <2%; **OOPE ~64% → ~39–40%**; **JSY 2005, JSSK 2011, PMSMA 2016 (9th), LaQshya 2017, SUMAN 2019, PMMVY 2017, RBSK 2013 (4 Ds), RKSK 2014, Mission Indradhanush 2014, U-WIN**; **Dialysis 2016**; **Tele-MANAS Oct 2022 (14416)**; **MHCA 2017**; **Sickle Cell Mission July 2023 (Shahdol; 2047)**; **AP: Aarogyasri 2007 → Dr NTR Vaidya Seva (2024); 104, 108; village health clinics**.

Test yourself: 8 questions (tap an option to see the answer)

PRACTICE

Consider the following statements:

1. A Primary Health Centre is meant to serve about 30,000 people in the plains.

2. A Community Health Centre serves about 1,20,000 people in the plains.

3. Under the NHM there is usually one ASHA for about 1,000 people.

4. PM-JAY provides cover of up to ₹5 lakh per family per year.

Which of the above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only

B. 1, 3 and 4 only

C. 2, 3 and 4 only

D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: D. All four statements are correct.

PRACTICE

Match List-I (scheme) with List-II (purpose):

List-I (scheme)	List-II (purpose)
A. Janani Suraksha Yojana	1. Mental health helpline
B. PM Surakshit Matritva Abhiyan	2. Cash incentive for institutional delivery
C. Rashtriya Bal Swasthya Karyakram	3. Screening children for the '4 Ds'
D. Tele-MANAS	4. Free antenatal check-up on the 9th of every month

(1) A → 4 | B → 2 | C → 3 | D → 1

(2) A → 2 | B → 4 | C → 3 | D → 1

(3) A → 2 B → 3 C → 4 D → 1

(4) A → 2 B → 4 C → 1 D → 3

Answer: (2) JSY: cash for institutional delivery; PMSMA: check-up on the 9th; RBSK: 4 Ds; Tele-MANAS: mental health helpline.

PRACTICE

Which one of the following statements is NOT correct?

A. Health and Wellness Centres were renamed Ayushman Arogya Mandirs.

B. The National Health Policy 2017 aimed at government health spending of 2.5% of GDP by 2025.

C. PM-JAY covers only people above 70 years of age.

D. The National Medical Commission replaced the Medical Council of India.

Answer: C. PM-JAY covers eligible families of all ages; since October 2024 it also covers everyone aged 70 and above regardless of income.

PRACTICE

Assertion (A): High out-of-pocket health spending pushes many Indian families into debt and poverty.
Reason (R): A large share of health costs in India is paid directly by households at the time of treatment.
Choose the correct answer:

A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

C. A is true but R is false

D. A is false but R is true

Answer: A. Both are true, and direct payment at the time of illness is exactly what causes the financial hardship.

PRACTICE

A 72-year-old person with a middle-class income in Andhra Pradesh, not covered by any family health scheme, needs hospital surgery. Under which central initiative can this person get cashless cover?

A. Janani Suraksha Yojana

B. Ayushman Vay Vandana card under PM-JAY

C. Rashtriya Bal Swasthya Karyakram

D. Mission Indradhanush

Answer: B. Since October 2024, everyone aged 70+ is eligible for PM-JAY through the Ayushman Vay Vandana card, regardless of income.

PRACTICE

Consider the following statements:

I. The Infant Mortality Rate is the number of deaths of infants under one year per 1,000 live births.

II. The Maternal Mortality Ratio is the number of maternal deaths per 1,00,000 live births.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. I only

B. II only

C. Both I and II

D. Neither I nor II

Answer: C. Both definitions are correct; note the different bases (1,000 and 1,00,000).

PRACTICE

Consider the following pairs (scheme – year launched):

1. National Rural Health Mission – 2005

2. National Urban Health Mission – 2013

3. Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission – 2021

4. National Sickle Cell Anaemia Elimination Mission – 2023

How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?

A. Only one pair

B. Only two pairs

C. Only three pairs

D. All four pairs

Answer: D. All four years are correct.

PRACTICE

Arrange the following in chronological order of launch:

1. Tele-MANAS

2. National Rural Health Mission

3. PM Jan Arogya Yojana

4. Rashtriya Bal Swasthya Karyakram

Select the correct order:

A. 2, 4, 3, 1

B. 4, 2, 3, 1

C. 2, 3, 4, 1

D. 2, 4, 1, 3

Answer: A. NRHM 2005 → RBSK 2013 → PM-JAY 2018 → Tele-MANAS 2022.

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

1. Write the constitutional position, the tiers with norms, NHM and ASHA, and Ayushman Bharat with digital health. 2. Write the outcome indicators with definitions and figures, and the spending and out-of-pocket facts. 3. Write the mother-child programmes, the newer missions with years and AP's scheme.

NOTEBOOK PAGE · Day 36: write this from memory

Close the notes. Write these headings, fill every blank, then correct in a different colour.

GEOGRAPHY: Andhra Pradesh: soils and vegetation

Area	Write
Soils	Five soil groups with regions and crops; soil problems (erosion, salinity, waterlogging, alkalinity) and remedies; soil-related schemes
Vegetation	Forest cover figures; five forest types with regions and trees; important trees and minor forest produce; State symbols; national parks, tiger reserve, sanctuaries, biosphere reserve, Ramsar site; rare species

ECONOMY: Inflation

- Meaning and formula; types by cause and speed; related terms (deflation, disinflation, reflation, stagflation, skewflation, core, headline); measures (WPI, CPI, CPI-IW, CPI-AL/RL, GDP deflator) with agency

and base; effects on groups; Phillips curve; remedies (monetary, fiscal, supply-side) with examples; India's target and recent trend.

SCIENCE: Healthcare delivery and programmes

Write: Constitution and health (State List, Art 21, 47); the tiers with population norms; NHM, ASHA; Ayushman Bharat (Arogya Mandirs, PM-JAY, Vay Vandana), ABDM, e-Sanjeevani, Jan Aushadhi; outcome indicators (IMR, MMR, TFR, life expectancy, institutional delivery, immunisation) with figures; spending and out-of-pocket share; mother-child programmes; recent missions (sickle cell, Tele-MANAS, dialysis, U-WIN); AP's health scheme.